It's Not a Sport

By George Carlin

SPEAKER: **(Pg 106-109)** To my way of thinking there are really only three sports: baseball, basketball, and football. Everything else is either a game or an activity.

INTRODUCTION

Golf would be much more interesting and exciting if they had goalies. . . Seriously, just think about it. . . In virtually every sport you have an opponent whose sole purpose in life is to keep you from achieving your goal. . . What's the challenge in golf? Heck, at least train a couple of gerbils to guard each hole. As a matter of fact, there's probably a multitude of alleged sports that in reality, any jury in its right mind would conclude . . .

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SPEAKER: **Hockey** comes to mind. People think hockey is a sport. It's not. Hockey is three activities taking place at the same time: ice skating, fooling around with a puck, and beating the crap out of somebody. If these guys had more brains then teeth, they'd do these things one at a time. First go ice-skating, then fool around with a puck, then you go to the bar and beat the crap out of somebody. The day would last longer, and these guys would have a lot more fun. Another reason why hockey isn't a sport is that it's not played with a ball. Anything not played with a ball can't be a sport. These are my rules, I make 'em up.

Soccer. Soccer is not a sport because you can't use your arms. Anything where you can't use your arms can't be a sport. Tap dancing isn't a sport. I rest my case.

Running. People think running is a sport. Running isn't a sport because anybody can do it. I can run, you can run. For Christ sakes, my mother can run! You don't see her on the cover of Sports Illustrated, do you?

Swimming. Swimming isn't a sport. Swimming is a way to keep from drowning. That's just common sense. Sailing isn't a sport. Sailing is a way to get somewhere. Riding the bus isn't a sport, why should sailing be a sport?

Boxing is not a sport either. Boxing is a way to beat the crap out of somebody. In that respect, boxing is actually

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a more sophisticated way of hockey. In spite of what the police tell you, beating the crap out of somebody is not a sport. When police brutality becomes an Olympic event, fine, then boxing can be a sport.

Bowling. Bowling isn't a sport because you have to rent shoes. Don't forget, these are my rules. I make 'em up.

Billiards. Some people think billiards is a sport, but it can't be, because there's no chance of serious injury. Unless, of course, you welch on a bet in a tough neighborhood. Then, if you wind up with a pool cue stickin' out of your ear, you know you might be the victim of a sports-related injury. But that ain't billiards, that's pool, and that starts with a P, and that rhymes with D, and that brings me to darts.

Darts could have been a sport, because at least there's a chance to put someone's eye out. But, alas, darts will never be a sport, because the whole object of the game is to reach zero, which goes against all sports logic.

Lacrosse is not a sport; lacrosse is a college activity. I don't care how rough it is, anytime you're running

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around a field, waving a stick with a little net on the end of it, you're engaged in a college activity. Period.

Field hockey and fencing. Same thing. Also these activities aren't sports, because you can't gamble on them. Anything you can't gamble on can't be a sport. When was the last time you made a fencing bet?

Gymnastics is not a sport because Romanians are good at it. It took me a long time to come up with that rule, but, I did it.

Polo isn't a sport. Polo is golf on horseback. Without holes. It's a great concept, but not a sport. And as far as water polo is concerned, I hesitate to even mention it, because it's extremely cruel to horses.

Which brings me to **hunting**. You think hunting is a sport? Ask the deer. The only good thing about hunting is the many fatal accidents on the weekends. And, of course, the permanently disfigured hunters who survive such accidents.

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Then you have **tennis**. Tennis is very trendy and very fruity, but it's not a sport. It's just a way to meet other trendy fruits. Technically, tennis is an advanced form a Ping-Pong. In fact, tennis is Ping-Pong played while standing on the table. Great concept, not a sport.

In fact, all racket games are nothing more than derivatives of Ping-Pong. Even **volleyball** is, technically, racketless, team Ping-Pong played with an inflated ball and raised net while standing on the table.

And finally welcome to **golf**. Let it just be said golf is a game that might possibly be fun, if it could be played alone. But it's the vacuous, striving, superficial, male-bonding joiners one has to associate with that makes it such a repulsive pastime. And it is decidedly not a sport.

Period.

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